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Samsung Galaxy Buds2

Tailor-made for Samsung users

Samsung's foray into the true wireless earbuds market has mostly been a successful one and the company's latest in this segment are the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 that launched alongside the Galaxy Fold3 and Flip3 smartphones. Priced at ₹11,999, the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 are technically the successors to the original Samsung Galaxy Buds that launched way back in 2019, but the improvements seen in this iteration make them a solid upgrade even over the Samsung Galaxy Buds+. Let's find out how they fare in our review.



BUILD AND COMFORT

The Samsung Galaxy Buds2 are a departure from the design language of the original Galaxy Buds and Galaxy Buds+. They resemble the Galaxy Buds Pro more with a clamshell charging case design. All the colour variants sport a white-coloured glossy finish on the charging case and opening up the case reveals the dual-tone design. These buds are also a lot lighter and smaller compared to the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro and the Buds+.

With each earbud weighing merely 5g, the difference is immediately felt. The earbuds are diminutive in size and fit inside the ear snugly. Due to the smaller size and lighter weight, you can wear these buds for longer periods of time without any discomfort. They do only come with an IPX2 rating, so we wouldn't feel comfortable recommending using these earphones when working out.

FEATURES

The Active Noise Cancellation performance of the Galaxy Buds2 is pretty decent on these buds and matches up to the performance delivered by its more expensive sibling – the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro. Low-end, constant sounds are easily mitigated, however, the buds don't perform as well as

say the Sony WF-1000XM3 at diminishing high-frequency sounds such as mechanical keyboards, people speaking, and more. Another appealing feature is the Galaxy Wearable app that allows users to access many features and tweak some earbud settings. The app lets you control noise cancellation modes, tweak around some touch controls, choose between EQ settings, perform the earbud fit test, use the Find my earbuds feature, and more. The app is barebones when it comes to control customisability. All you can do is tweak the touch and hold function. We wish Samsung allowed users to control not just one but all controls. You can also toggle on Bixby voice-wake up within the app and use handsfree assistant on Samsung devices.

The Galaxy Wearable app is available for all Android devices but the Buds2 are not compatible with the iOS Samsung app yet so you won't be able to use any of the app features if you're an iOS user.

PERFORMANCE

The earbuds come packing a 2-Way driver setup with one woofer and one

tweeter. As with most of the company's audio devices, the Buds2 are tuned in collaboration with AKG. As for audio codecs, the earphones support the SBC, AAC and Samsung Scalable codecs.

The bass response of the buds is exaggerated quite a bit, more so than its more expensive sibling – the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro. So, the sound may get slightly muddy occasionally. The mids, however, are properly highlighted. The treble quality is slightly inconsistent, at times it sounds nice and bright, but it can get a bit too harsh.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life of the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 is nothing to write home about. With ANC on, the battery life is rated at 5 hours on the buds alone and 20 hours coupled with the charging case.



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In our tests, we got about 4.5 hours of playtime on the buds alone with ANC turned on and the volume levels set to around 60 per cent. There's a quick charge feature where 5 minutes of charging gets you about an hour's worth of playtime.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy Buds2 are, no doubt, a substantial improvement over the original Galaxy Buds offering better sound quality, active noise cancellation and a phenomenal fit. The earbuds also offer decent ANC performance and a warm sound profile with a spacious enough soundstage. They are a pretty good option to consider under 15K, especially if you own a Samsung device.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

BLUETOOTH VERSION: Bluetooth v5.2 | EARBUD WEIGHT: 5.0 g (each) | BATTERY LIFE (EARBUDS): 5 hours (with ANC on), 7.5 hours (with ANC off) | BATTERY LIFE (TOTAL): 20 hours (with ANC on), 29 hours (with ANC off) | WIRELESS CHARGING: Yes, Qi-charging enabled | IP RATING: IPX2 | DRIVER SETUP: 2-way driver setup, 1 woofer, 1 tweeter | AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC, Samsung Scalable Codec

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